

Continue the Story

Name:

Date set:

Due:

READ THE EXTRACT, THEN CONTINUE THE STORY

The tide had gone out further than usual, and Elias almost missed it — a rusted tin, half-buried beside a rock pool, its lid held shut with a knot of string that had gone stiff and green with age. He nearly left it where it was. He was already going to be late for the bus, and old tins washed up on this stretch of beach every winter, mostly full of nothing. But something made him crouch down anyway and start working at the knot.

The extract finishes with Elias about to open the tin. Continue the story, in which you explain what he finds inside, what he does next, and why it matters to him.

- A description of what's inside the tin
- How Elias's feelings change over the course of the scene
- Both dialogue and description
- Why this discovery matters to him

STRUCTURE

Pick up exactly where the extract ends — don't restart the scene. Then: action → dialogue → sensory detail → a hook or twist. Keep going and finish the scene properly, don't stop at the exciting bit.

Action sentences	x2	Dialogue	x1
Sensory (3 details)	x1	Intriguing detail	x1
Semicolons	x2	Colons	x2
Foreshadowing / suspense	throughout	Genuine ending	not cut off

YOUR WRITING

CHECKLIST — GO OVER IT AGAIN

☐ **Read it all out loud first.**

2. ☐ **Dialogue tags** — "asked" / "he" / "she" after speech: lower case, not capital.
3. ☐ **New sentence inside speech marks** — starts with a capital. No full stop before "and."
4. ☐ **Was / were** — check it matches a singular or plural subject.
5. ☐ **Every sentence has a verb.**
6. ☐ **Ending is finished** — not notes, not cut off mid-action.

2 semicolons — somewhere in the piece

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2 colons — somewhere in the piece

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